support for the Dalai Lama and the Tibetan diaspora, thus indicating a somewhat greater accommodation of Chinese views. In April 2019, the Indian Navy participated with two warships in the 70th anniversary celebration of the PLA Navy. Finally, India joined the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation in 2018. These are all examples of clever Indian diplomatic statecraft in the aftermath of Doklam, all of which signal an interest in closer Sino–Indian co-operation.

Even if India is gradually engaging in deeper economic and diplomatic cooperation with China, this does not negate the fact that India is also engaged in a geopolitical rivalry with China. Furthermore, by not taking part in either of the two first Belt and Road Summits hosted by China, India has signalled its disagreement with Chinese BRI policy. Since coming into power, the Modi government has modestly but increasingly shown a willingness to voice India's view. Under Modi, India's China policy has demonstrated both co-operation and contestation. Accepting the assumption that internal and external military/alignment policies are stronger indicators than are economy and diplomacy and taking the totality of the three tendencies of increasing co-operation, enduring disagreement, and increasing rivalry, it appears that India is pursuing a policy with a slightly stronger touch of confrontation than of cooperation. Applying the framework presented in the introduction to this volume, India can be said to be engaging in a policy of conflictive hedging vis-à-vis China.

Notes

1 Liff, Adam P. (2016) "Whither the Balancers? The Case for a Methodological Reset." *Security Studies* 25, No. 2: pp. 420–459.